COLOURS OF CONSENT

PRIDE MARCH, 2008

Delhi, Kolkata, Bengaluru and Mumbai

46TH ANNIVERSARY
YOUTH UPRISINGS

It took 10 years of for the Pride movement to achieve its goal—the Supreme Court striking down Section 377 in 2018

Almost 150 years after the British made homosexuality a crime in India, members of the country's LGBTQ (lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender and queer) communities and their supporters organised protests across the country against Section 377. In Mumbai, a procession of around 500 people, some bearing rainbow flags, others wearing hats, feathers or masks, marched from August Kranti Maidan to Girgaum Chowpatty. In Delhi, a similar march went from Barakhamba Road to Jantar Mantar. Attendees spoke out against the persecution of minorities and the widespread misuse of Section 377 to stigmatise and harass homosexuals in India. The 2008 Pride March received enough support to become a yearly event in major Indian cities. After 10 years of continued efforts and protests, the movement achieved its goal—on September 6, 2018, the Supreme Court said using Section 377 to victmise homosexuals was unconstitutional, and decriminalised homosexuality. ■

– Sonali Acharjee

THE GAY WAY: Laws should be tools of social unity and should protect non-violent self-expression

AP/ MUSTAFA QURAISHI



People at the first Rainbow Pride Walk in Delhi, Jun. 29, 2008